

HOUSEPLANTS AND MODERN LIVING

Human beings evolved as hunter-gatherers with an intimate relationship to nature. But thanks to increasingly rapid technological change, most of us, according to the World Health Organization (WHO), now spend 90 percent of our time indoors, disconnected from plants and wildlife.

Nature on your windowsill

In recent decades, numerous scientific studies have provided a growing body of evidence to back up what experience seems to tell us: that engaging with plants and nature stimulates our senses, nourishes our minds, and has a beneficial effect on both our physical and mental well-being—to the extent that we should consider “nature deficit disorder” as a condition of our times.

Green-frame the problem

Of course, we can’t all suddenly return to the wild and live off the land, but bringing nature indoors by growing houseplants is the perfect first step toward reconnecting with the natural world. Nurturing just one plant on a windowsill starts to reestablish an intimacy with nature. As your collection grows, your houseplants can create a living green frame through which to connect the inside with the outside, both literally and metaphorically: softening the harsh grays and straight lines of the built environment, drawing attention toward the attractive prospect of nature, and reframing your mindset to seek it out.



Bring the outside in

Create a “green frame” of plants around your window or office space to reconnect with nature.